GOVERNMENT OF ANDHRA PRADESH

Municipal Elections – 2026
PHASE – II
23 ULBs



4 - Municipal Corporations

19 - Municipalities / Nagar Panchayats

09.11.2026

Election Authority and C&DMA,
Govt. of A.P.

Content

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

Coverage

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LEGAL FRAMEWORK
Constitution and Act – powers and functions of the SEC

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

Common to both: The substance of each power is identical. Only the enabling Act and section numbers differ.

Power / function	Municipal Corporations	Municipalities / Nagar Panchayats
Superintendence, direction and control of rolls and elections vests in SEC	Art. 243ZA & Sec. 9	Art. 243ZA & Sec. 10-A
SEC may issue directions for efficient conduct	Sec. 10(1) – to the Commissioner of the Corporation, District Collectors, any officer of Govt. / Corporation	Sec. 10-B(1) – to C&DMA, District Collectors, any officer of Govt. / Municipalities
Staff placed at SEC's disposal on request	Sec. 10(4) r/w Art. 243K(3)	Sec. 10-B(4) r/w Art. 243K(3)
Delegation of powers by the State Election Commissioner	Sec. 10(5)	Sec. 10-B(5)
Election staff deemed on deputation to SEC	Sec. 32-A	Sec. 343-Y(1)

LEGAL FRAMEWORK

Administrative machinery notified by the SEC

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

Tier	Municipal Corporations	Municipalities / Nagar Panchayats
Election Authority	*Commissioner & Director of Municipal Administration*	*Commissioner & Director of Municipal Administration*
District Election Authority	*District Collector, in the respective district*	*District Collector, in the respective district*
Additional Election Authorities	Commissioners of Municipal Corporations	— (tier not notified)
Additional District Election Authorities	*Regional Directors-cum-Appellate Commissioners of MA*	*Regional Directors-cum-Appellate Commissioners of MA*
Deputy District Election Authorities	— (tier not notified)	RDOs / Sub-Collectors, as the case may be
Assistant Election Authorities	— (tier not notified)	Municipal Commissioners

LEGAL FRAMEWORK

Appointment of election officers

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

Common to both

- **Cluster:** one officer for a cluster of 2 – 4 wards, as per SEC's instructions.
- **Assistants:** subject to the officer's control, competent to perform all or any of the officer's functions.
- **Exception:** an assistant shall not perform functions relating to scrutiny of nominations, unless the officer is unavoidably prevented.

Municipal Corporations

- **Designation:** Returning Officer (Sec. 25) and Assistant Returning Officer (Sec. 26).
- **RO:** appointed by the Commissioner of the Corporation with the approval of the Commission, for one or more wards.
- **ARO:** one or more, appointed by the Commissioner with APSEC's approval.

Municipalities / Nagar Panchayats

- **Designation:** Election Officer (EO) and Additional / Assistant EO. (Rule 3 of Election Rules, 2026 – G.O.Ms.No.213, dated 05.09.2026.)
- **EO:** any Gazetted officer of the State Government or a local authority.
- **Proposals:** Municipal Commissioner sends proposals through the Collector & DEA to the Election Authority and C&DMA.

PRE-NOMINATION

Election Notification and electoral rolls

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

Common to both

- **Notification:** issued by the SEC with dates for every stage – notice, nominations, scrutiny, withdrawal, list of contesting candidates, poll and counting.
- **Schedule:** strictly complies with the relevant provisions of election law.
- **Freezing:** ward-wise roll frozen on the date of the Election Notification.
- **Updation:** inclusions, deletions and transpositions ordered by the ERO under Sec. 22 / 23, R.P. Act, 1950 up to that date are carried into the ward rolls.
- **Copies:** keep sufficient printed copies of the updated rolls ready.

Municipal Corporations

- Ward-wise roll of the Corporation; rolls so updated are used for the election.

Municipalities / Nagar Panchayats

- **Display:** EO displays the updated ward voter lists on the Notice Board on the day of the Election Notice (Rule 5, Election Rules).

PRE-NOMINATION

Public Notice vs Election Notice

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

Aspect	Municipal Corporations	Municipalities / Nagar Panchayats
Name of the notice	Public Notice of Election	Election Notice
Issued and signed by	Returning Officer only	Election Officer only
Format	Form 7 of Schedule-A of the Act	As pescribed by SEC.
Display	Corporation notice board and conspicuous places in each ward	Municipal office notice board and conspicuous places in each ward
Offices shown separately	Mayor and Ward Members	Chairperson and Ward Member

Common to both: Issued in the morning of the appointed date, well before nominations open. Specifies particulars of election, reservation, place, dates and hours for nominations, scrutiny, withdrawal and poll. All statutory and non-statutory forms secured before the date of notice – separately for each office. Blank nomination forms and declaration formats supplied free of cost to all intending candidates.

Key differences at a glance (1 of 2)

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

Aspect	Municipal Corporations	Municipalities / Nagar Panchayats
Governing Act	A.P. Municipal Corporations Act, 1955	A.P. Municipalities Act, 1965
Head of the Elected Body	Mayor	Chairperson
Election officers	Returning Officer (Sec. 25) and Asst. Returning Officer (Sec. 26)	Election Officer (EO) and Additional / Assistant EO
Appointment of officer	By Commissioner of the Corporation, with SEC approval	Gazetted officer; proposals by Municipal Commissioner via Collector & DEA to EA and C&DMA
Tiers of machinery	EA, DEA, Additional EAs (Corporation Commissioners), Additional DEAs (RDs)	EA, DEA, Additional DEAs (RDs), Deputy DEAs (RDOs / Sub-Collectors), Assistant EAs (Municipal Commissioners)
Notice of election	Public Notice in Form 7 of Schedule-A of the Act	Election Notice in SEC-designed format, English and Telugu
Nomination deposit	Rs.5,000/- (Rs.2,500/- for SC / ST / BC)	Rs.3,000/- (Rs.1,500/- for SC / ST / BC)
Antecedents / assets / education	Affidavit on Rs.20 stamp paper before Notary / First Class Magistrate	Declaration attested by two witnesses

NOMINATIONS

Filing of nominations

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

11 AM – 3 PM
All notified days, incl. public holidays

4
Max. nomination sets per candidate per ward / office

1 vehicle
Allowed within 100 m of the office

3 persons
Allowed inside, incl. candidate / proposer

Common to both: Signed by candidate and proposer; presented in person by either of them – **not by post, not through any other person, not after the appointed time**.

Aspect	Municipal Corporations	Municipalities / Nagar Panchayats
No. of Sets	Rule 4(1)(b)	Rule 8(1)
Candidate not enrolled in the ward	RO may require copy / certified entries of the roll [Sec. 36(7)]	EO may require copy / entries and verify candidate and proposer [Rule 9]
On receipt	Form-IV: serial number, date and hour certified. Form-V: receipt and notice of scrutiny	EO enters date, time, initials, running serial number; receipt in Form-I

NOMINATIONS

Documents to be filed and deposit

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

Document	Municipal Corporations	Municipalities / Nagar Panchayats
Deposit – general	Rs.5,000/-	Rs.3,000/-
Deposit – SC / ST / BC	Rs.2,500/- with Form-II and community certificate (reserved or unreserved seat)	Rs.1,500/- with community certificate (reserved or unreserved seat)
Community declaration	Form-II; certificate from competent authority	Form-II / certificate before officer not below Deputy Tahsildar (reserved seats)
Choice of symbols	Form-I	Form-IA [Rule 8(9)]
Criminal antecedents, assets & liabilities, education	Affidavit [Rule 4(4)] on Rs.20 non-judicial stamp paper, sworn before Notary / First Class Magistrate	Declaration [Rule 8(10)] attested by two witnesses
Model Code of Conduct	Form-III – declaration to abide	-
Not disqualified under the Act	-	Declaration required
Maintenance of expenditure accounts	*Declaration required*	*Declaration required*

Common to both: No column of the affidavit / declaration to be left blank – write "Nil" or "Not applicable".

NOMINATIONS

Checklist and list of nominations received

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

Common to both

- **Preliminary examination:** of the nomination paper and enclosures by the officer.
- **Checklist:** defects and documents due endorsed; original kept with nomination, duplicate to candidate / proposer.
- **Pending documents:** to be submitted before 3:00 PM on the last date for nominations.
- **Language:** list of nominations published in Telugu.

Municipal Corporations

- **Form-VI:** notice of nominations received published after 3 PM on each day.

Municipalities / Nagar Panchayats

- **Form-III:** list of nominations published on the last day, immediately after the hour fixed for receipt is past.

QUALIFICATIONS

Qualification of candidates

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

21 years

Minimum age of the candidate

Enrolled

Name must be in the electoral roll of the ULB (any ward)

Crucial date for qualification / disqualification

Scrutiny date

In respect of Municipalities/NPs &

Date of Election

in respect of Municipal Corporations

Common to both

Aspect	Municipal Corporations	Municipalities / Nagar Panchayats
Offices, Seats	Mayor and Ward Member	Chairperson and Ward Member
Electoral roll	Roll of the Municipal Corporation	Roll of the Municipality concerned
Proposer – Ward Member	*Registered voter of the same ward*	*Registered voter of the same ward*
Proposer – Mayor / Chairperson	Registered voter of the Municipal Corporation	Registered voter of the Municipality

DISQUALIFICATIONS

Disqualifications (1) – convictions and election offences

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

Common to both – R.P. Act, 1951, Sec. 8 (age bar 21, not 25)

- **Sec. 8(1) offence:** fine only – 6 years from conviction; imprisonment – from conviction till 6 years after release.
- **Sec. 8(2) offence, ≥ 6 months / any other offence, ≥ 2 years:** from conviction till 6 years after release.
- **Trial court conviction :** attracts disqualification; release on bail does not remove it unless the conviction is stayed.

Aspect	Municipal Corporations	Municipalities / Nagar Panchayats
Linking provision	Sec. 21-A r/w Sec. 8, R.P. Act	Sec. 13-A r/w Sec. 8, R.P. Act
Election offences / corrupt practice – 6 years	Sec. 20-A (Ch. IXA IPC; corrupt practice; Sec. 599–610, 610-A, 611)	Sec. 15-A (Ch. IXA IPC; corrupt practice; Ch. III, Part VI offences)
Failure to lodge expense account – 3 years	Sec. 20-B	Sec. 15-B
PCR Act, 1955 / moral delinquency	Not listed in the Corporations deck	Sec. 15(1) – during sentence and 5 years thereafter

DISQUALIFICATIONS

Disqualifications (2) – office, interest and dues

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

Ground	Municipal Corporations	Municipalities / Nagar Panchayats
Unsound mind; deaf-mute; leper	Sec. 22(1)(b)	Sec. 15(2)(a)
Office of profit	Sec. 22(1)(c) – Govt., the Corporation or any local authority	Sec. 14 – a Municipality, Central or State Govt.
Insolvency	Sec. 22(1)(d)	Sec. 15(2)(b)
Judicial / magisterial office	Sec. 22(1)(e) – judicial office within city limits	Sec. 15(2)(e) – honorary Magistrate in the town
Paid legal practitioner	Sec. 22(1)(f) – for / against the Corporation	Sec. 15(2)(d) – for / against the Council
Interest in contract / work	Sec. 22(1)(h) – contract or employment with the Corporation	Sec. 15(2)(c) – subsisting lease, contract or work with the Municipality
Dismissal for misconduct	Sec. 22(1)(i)	Sec. 15(2)(i)
Arrears of municipal dues	Not listed in the Corporations deck	Sec. 15(2)(h) – dues up to previous year, after bill / notice
Specific exception	UDA Chairman for the Corporation area [proviso, Sec. 22(1)(c)]	Defaulter who pays dues and obtains receipt before scrutiny

NOMINATIONS

Scrutiny of nominations

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

Common to both

- Date and time as fixed in the Election Notification.
- Conducted by the officer personally; assistant only if the officer is unavoidably prevented.
- May attend: candidate, election agent, proposer and one authorised person (presence not mandatory).
- Quasi-judicial, summary enquiry – the officer does not become a court.
- Every nomination set scrutinised, even if one set is accepted.
- Inspection of papers allowed, but not handling.
- Officer may object suo motu; every objection decided with recorded reasons.
- Objected candidate may rebut up to the next day; scrutiny of others continues.
- Copy of rejection order furnished to the candidate.

Municipal Corporations

- **Officer:** Returning Officer (ARO as fallback).
- **Place:** as specified in the Public Notice.

Municipalities / Nagar Panchayats

- **Officer:** Election Officer (AEO as fallback).
- **Place:** as specified in the EO's Election Notice.
- **Additional point:** a proposer signing more than one nomination – only the first received is valid.

NOMINATIONS

Grounds for rejection of nominations

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

Common to both

- Candidate not in the electoral roll of the ULB.
- Proposer not in the ward roll (Member) / ULB roll (Mayor / Chairperson).
- Not delivered at the place specified in the notice.
- Delivered by a person other than the candidate or proposer, or to a person other than the officer / authorised person.
- Not substantially in the prescribed form; not signed at the places meant.
- Deposit not made in accordance with law; signature not genuine.
- Reserved seat (SC / ST / BC / Women) and candidate not of that category.
- No rejection on the ground of any defect which is not of a substantial character. Mistake/Error of a Technical or Clerical nature should be ignored.
- Officer's decision is final – challengeable only by election petition after the result.

Municipal Corporations

- **Ineligible under:** Sec. 20-A, 20-B, 21, 21-A or 22.
- **Non-compliance:** Sec. 36 / 37, Rule 3 (deposit), Rule 4 (declarations / affidavit).
- **Also:** proposer disqualified under Sec. 36(2); prescribed affidavit not filed.

Municipalities / Nagar Panchayats

- **Ineligible under:** Sec. 13, 13-A, 14, 15, 15-A or 15-B.
- **Non-compliance:** Rules 8, 9 and 10 (nomination, roll entry, deposit).
- **Also:** declaration on antecedents, assets & education not filed / not attested by two witnesses.

NOMINATIONS

After scrutiny and withdrawal of candidature

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

Aspect	Municipal Corporations	Municipalities / Nagar Panchayats
Certificate of scrutiny	Form-VII, signed by the RO	Not specified
List of validly nominated candidates	Form-VIII, affixed on notice board	Form-IV, affixed on notice board
Notice of withdrawal	Form-9 of Schedule-A	Form-V
Receipt of withdrawal	Form-IX	Form-V
Publication of withdrawals	Form-X	Form-VI

Common to both: **Only one entry per candidate in the valid list**, however many sets are accepted.
Withdrawal notice signed and delivered in person before 3:00 PM on the notified date; if the candidate cannot, the proposer or an election **agent authorised in writing** may deliver it. Officer verifies genuineness and identity. A withdrawal, once submitted, cannot be withdrawn/cancelled; no retirement from contest after the last date.

NOMINATIONS

Contesting more than one seat

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

Common to both

- A candidate may contest from more than one ward, or for both head of council and Ward Member.
- **Choice:** written intimation to the Commissioner within 15 days of the result of the last ward / position.
- **Effect:** declared elected for the chosen seat; other seats fall vacant; choice is final.
- **No choice made:** election to all such wards / positions becomes void.
- **Either way:** SEC starts fresh election proceedings for the resulting vacancies.

Municipal Corporations

- **Positions:** Mayor and Ward Member.
- **Provisions:** result published under Sec. 66; Rule 120(1), A.P. Municipal Corporations Election of Mayor, Ward Members Rules, 2026.

Municipalities / Nagar Panchayats

- **Positions:** Chairperson and Ward Member.
- **Provision:** Rule 62, Election Rules; intimation to the Municipal Commissioner.

CANDIDATES

Form-A and Form-B – setting up of party candidates

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

No substantive difference. The only variation is the addressee: Returning Officer (Corporations) / Election Officer (Municipalities / NPs).

Timelines

- **Form-A:** to Collector & DEA before 5:00 PM, last date for nominations.
- **Form-A copy:** DEA to RO / EO before 3:00 PM, last date for withdrawal.
- **Form-B:** to RO / EO before 3:00 PM, last date for withdrawal; delivery is the party's responsibility.
- **Signatories:** President / General Secretary (State unit for National Parties); ink only – no facsimile, stamp or fax.

Parties entitled

- Recognised National Parties registered with APSEC
- Recognised State Parties of A.P. and other States
- Registered parties with a reserved symbol
- Registered parties without a reserved symbol, incl. common free symbol (Para 6A)
- **Conditions:** party declaration in nomination; name on party rolls; Form-A / B in time.

Special situations

- **Substitution:** revised Form-B stating earlier one rescinded; same signatory; before 3 PM.
- **Two Form-Bs, no rescission:** accept for the candidate whose nomination was delivered first.
- **Substitute (dummy):** counts only if main candidate is rejected or withdraws.
- **Independent:** if Form-A / B not produced in time, or no party declaration.

CANDIDATES

Contesting list, symbols and uncontested election

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

Common to both

- **List:** in Telugu; three categories (recognised parties, registered parties, independents); serial numbers run consecutively.
- **Order:** Telugu alphabetical order of surnames (proper name if none); initials and titles ignored; same names by occupation / residence.
- **Ballot:** same serial order; symbol name only in the list; copy to every candidate and on notice board.
- **Symbols:** recognised / reserved – party symbol; Para 6A – common symbol; others – 3 free-symbol preferences, registered parties ahead of independents, lot on clash; sitting holder keeps symbol; leftovers allotted at the end.
- **Uncontested:** one valid candidate after withdrawal – declared elected forthwith; copies to SEC, EA & C&DMA, Collector & DEA and Commissioner.

Municipal Corporations

- **List form:** Form-XI, under Rule 9 of the Election Rules.
- **Uncontested copy:** to the Commissioner of the Corporation.

Municipalities / Nagar Panchayats

- **List form:** Form-VII, under Rule 14(1).
- **Uncontested copy:** to the Municipal Commissioner.

BALLOT PAPERS

Postal ballot papers

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

Common to both

- **Eligible:** service voters and their wives (Armed Forces; State Armed Police outside the State); voters under preventive detention; voters on election duty who opt.
- **Ballot:** names and party affiliation, no symbol; NOTA in the last panel.
- **Wife of service voter:** ballot in a separate cover.
- **Despatch:** within 48 hours after the last hour of withdrawal.
- **Marking:** PS No. and Sl. No. on counterfoil; "P.B." against the voter in the marked copy.
- **Deadline:** must reach the officer before the hour fixed for commencement of counting.

Municipal Corporations

- **Form-XXVI:** declaration by voter.
- **Form-XXVII:** small cover, ballot number on face.
- **Form-XXVIII:** medium cover addressed to the RO.
- **Form-XXIX:** instructions to voters (Part-II: return deadline).

Municipalities / Nagar Panchayats

- **Basis:** Rule 22 to 27 of the Election Rules, 2026 – G.O.Ms.No.213, MA&UD (G) Dept., dt.05.09.2026.
- **Form-XIII:** letter to voter. Form-XII: envelope addressed to EO; plus envelope with ballot number.

BALLOT PAPERS

Printing of regular ballot papers

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

Common to both

- **Quantity:** ward electorate + 10%, rounded to nearest 50; per PS rounded to nearest 10.
- **Roles:** DEA – printing, presses, police security; SEC – symbols and specifications.
- **Content:** names and symbols as per the contesting list, NOTA in the last panel.
- **Officer's steps:** furnish list to DEA; liaise with press; proof-read block; strike order; verify serial numbers; confirm own wards; transport to ULB HQ under security; sort PS-wise; check each ballot 2 – 3 times before issue.

Municipal Corporations

- **Paper:** C&DMA supplies White Wove and Pink Wove paper.
- **List used:** Form-XI.
- **Nodal Officer:** coordinates between ROs and presses.

Municipalities / Nagar Panchayats

- **Paper:** C&DMA supplies White Wove and Pink Wove paper.
- **List used:** Form-VII.

POLL

Model Code of Conduct and agents

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

Common to both: MCC in force from the day SEC issues the schedule, across urban areas of the State; binds candidates, agents, parties, Ministers, Govt. and local body employees; Static and Mobile Teams to monitor. Polling agents: 1 + 2 relief per PS, voters of the same / neighbouring PS in the ward, intimated ≥ 3 days before poll.

Aspect	Municipal Corporations	Municipalities / Nagar Panchayats
Election agent	Form-XII; revocation Form-XIII; one per candidate	Form-VIII; revocation effective on lodging with EO
Polling agent	Form-XIV (duplicate to PO); revocation Form-XVI	Form-IX (duplicate to PO)
Counting agent	Form-XV, produced ≥ 1 hour before counting; revocation Form-XVII	Form-X
Number of counting agents	One per counting table + one at the RO's table	One per counting table + one at the EO's table
MCC violations prosecuted under	IPC / BNS / BNSS, A.P. Municipal Corporations Act, 1955	IPC / BNS / BNSS, A.P. Municipalities Act, 1965

POLL

Polling stations, personnel and poll day

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

Common to both

- **PS layout:** secrecy of compartment, lighting for symbols, waiting space, one-way flow.
- **Sensitive PS measures:** police, cameras / webcasting (feeds preserved), Micro-Observers, EPIC checks, ASD list verification.
- **Personnel:** no posting in native / working ULB; staff from another Revenue Division; randomisation; training and rehearsals.
- **Material:** sufficient boxes and seals; 4 roll copies per PS (1 marked + 3 working).
- **Distinguishing mark:** ULB code – Ward No. / PS Sl. No.; stamped and signed by PO in advance.
- **Poll day:** 7:00 AM – 5:00 PM; area notice and candidate poster; one box in use at a time.

Municipal Corporations

- **Owner-candidate building:** inform the Commissioner; shift PS within the ward.
- **Sensitive PS list:** SHO with Municipal officials and Tahsildar.
- **PO / OPO appointed by:** the RO, for each PS in assigned wards.

Municipalities / Nagar Panchayats

- **Owner-candidate building:** report to DEA through the Municipal Commissioner; shift within ward.
- **Sensitive PS list:** SHO with Municipal Commissioner and Tahsildar; also build confidence among vulnerable sections.
- **PO / OPO appointed by:** the DEA (or authorised officer).

COUNTING

Receipt of polled material and covers

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

Common to both

- **Reception Centre = Counting Centre;** no transit reception centre.
- **Ward-wise receipt:** boxes and material into strong rooms; floor squares marked PS-wise in advance.
- **Colour-coded covers from POs:** BROWN (with boxes – statutory accounts, PO's Diary, marked roll, used / unused ballots and counterfoils); GREEN – statutory; YELLOW – non-statutory; BLUE – plain cover (stamps, ink, seals, handbook).

Municipal Corporations

- **Forms in covers:** Tendered votes Form-XIX; Challenged votes Form-XX; Blind / infirm voters Form-XVIII; Election Duty Certificates Form-XXIV.

Municipalities / Nagar Panchayats

- **Forms in covers:** Tendered votes Form-XVI; Form X-C and Forms XIV, XV, XVII.

COUNTING

Counting preliminaries and postal ballots

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

Common to both: Counting continuous till completion; assistants briefed; present – candidate, election agent, one counting agent per table, staff, SEC-authorised persons; PO Diaries verified; postal ballots counted first. Late covers rejected unopened. Defective / missing declaration – reject without opening the inner cover. Valid declarations kept separately. Rejection grounds: no vote, votes for > 1, spurious, mutilated, not in the officer's cover, doubtful mark, identifying mark.

Aspect	Municipal Corporations	Municipalities / Nagar Panchayats
Secrecy provision read out	Sec. 602; breach under Sec. 602(2) – up to 3 months, or fine, or both	Sec. 343-F – up to 3 months, or fine, or both
Postal voter's declaration	Form-XXVI	Form-XI
Postal ballot totals entered in	Form-XXX	Form-XX

COUNTING

Counting tables and stages

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

- **Table:** attached to one officer only; boxes opened one PS at a time; seals checked by agents first.
- **Stage I:** verify box identity and seal; ballots out unfolded, bundles of 25; tally with Ballot Paper Account; mix in drum – at most one bundle below 25.
- **Stage II:** 40 bundles (1,000 ballots) drawn at random per round; tray = candidates + NOTA + 1 doubtful; valid votes in bundles of 100; doubtful votes to the officer.
- **Rejection:** identifying mark; no / misplaced mark or wrong instrument; > 1 candidate; doubtful; spurious; mutilated; wrong serial / design; lacks distinguishing mark or PO's signature.

COUNTING

Recount, declaration and safe custody

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

Aspect	Municipal Corporations	Municipalities / Nagar Panchayats
Result sheet	Form-XXX	Form-XX Part-I
Declaration of result	Form-XXXI	Form-XX Part-II
Certificate of Election	Form-XXXIII, with acknowledgement	-
Copy of declaration to	SEC, EA, DEA and Commissioner	SEC, EA, DEA and Municipal Commissioner

Common to both: Announce votes and pause; allow 15 minutes for recount requests; decide on grounds and amend the result sheet if allowed; no recount after signing. Tie decided by lot – 5 slips per candidate, name drawn first elected. Candidate-wise valid and invalid ballots bundled and sealed (agents may add seals); steel trunks to DEA the same day or by noon next day; Treasury / Sub-Treasury under double lock; opened only on order of an Election Tribunal or competent court. Detailed Counting Procedure to be issued by APSEC.

PRE-NOMINATION

Stage-wise concordance of forms

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

Stage	Municipal Corporations	Municipalities / Nagar Panchayats
Notice of election	Form 7, Schedule-A	SEC- Prescribed format
Receipt of nomination	Form-IV (certify) & Form-V (receipt + scrutiny notice)	Form-I (receipt)
List of nominations received	Form-VI (daily, after 3 PM)	Form-III (last day)
Certificate of scrutiny	Form-VII	Not specified
Validly nominated candidates	Form-VIII	Form-IV
Withdrawal: notice / receipt / publication	Form-9 Sch-A / Form-IX / Form-X	Form-V / Form-V / Form-VI
List of contesting candidates	Form-XI	Form-VII
Election / polling / counting agent	Form-XII / XIV / XV	Form-VIII / IX / X
Result sheet	Form-XXX	Form-XX Part-I
Declaration of result	Form-XXXI	Form-XX Part-II
Certificate of Election	Form-XXXIII	Not specified

SUMMARY

Key differences at a glance (2 of 2)

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

Aspect	Municipal Corporations	Municipalities / Nagar Panchayats
List of contesting candidates	Form-XI (Rule 9)	Form-VII (Rule 14(1))
Agents' forms	Election XII; Polling XIV; Counting XV	Election VIII; Polling IX; Counting X
Secrecy of voting	Sec. 602	Sec. 343-F
Result sheet / declaration	Form-XXX / Form-XXXI; Certificate in Form-XXXIII	Form-XX Part-I / Form-XX Part-II
Expenditure Ceiling	Mayor – GVMC : Rs.40.00 Lakhs & Other Corporations : Rs.25.00 Lakhs Ward Members – GVMC : Rs.15.00 Lakhs & Other Corporations : Rs.10.00 Lakhs	Chairperson – Municipalities : Rs.20.00 Lakhs & Nagarpanchayts : Rs.10.00 Lakhs Ward Members – Municipalities : Rs.7.50 Lakhs & Nagarpanchayts : Rs.5.00 Lakhs
Disqualification – no accounts	Sec. 20-B (3 years)	Sec. 15-B (3 years)

EXPENDITURE

Accounts of election expenses

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

Aspect	Municipal Corporations	Municipalities / Nagar Panchayats
Duty to keep accounts; ceiling by SEC	Sec. 617-B(1) to (3)	Sec. 343-ZC(1) to (3)
Formats and scrutiny authorities	SEC Order No.102/SEC-F1/2019, dt.01.03.2019	SEC Order No.135/SEC-F2/2019, dt.05.04.2019
Scrutiny officials (DEA to designate)	Circular No.102/SEC-F1/2019, dt.08.01.2020	Circular No.135/SEC-F2/2019, dt.08.01.2020
Failure to lodge – disqualification 3 years	Sec. 20-B	Sec. 15-B

Common to both: Separate, correct account from date of nomination to date of result (both inclusive); day-to-day account to the officer once every 3 days from publication of the contesting list.

SUMMARY

Key time limits at a glance – common to both

Corporations | Municipalities / NPs

Activity	Time limit – Corporations and Municipalities / NPs
Receipt of nominations	11:00 AM – 3:00 PM, all days incl. holidays
Pending documents under Checklist	Before 3:00 PM, last date for nominations
Form-A to Collector & DEA	Before 5:00 PM, last date for nominations
Withdrawal / Form-B to RO or EO	Before 3:00 PM, last date for withdrawal
Despatch of postal ballots	Within 48 hours of last hour of withdrawal
Polling agent intimation	At least 3 days before poll
Poll hours	7:00 AM – 5:00 PM
Expense account (concurrent)	Once every 3 days
Request for recount	15 minutes after announcement
Choice of seat (multiple wins)	Within 15 days of last result

Time limits are identical in both decks. Refer to SEC's Compendium of Instructions and the FAQs on Nomination Process and Model Code of Conduct.

Instructions on
Local Procurement of Election Material



GOVERNMENT OF ANDHRA PRADESH
MUNICIPAL ADMINISTRATION DEPARTMENT

O/o the Commissioner & Director of
Municipal Administration, A.P.,
4th Floor, APCRDA Project Office,
Rayapudi, Guntur Dist.-522237.

CIRCULAR

Roc.No.13021/122/2026/H1, dated 21-10-2026.

Sub: Municipal Administration Department – Municipal Elections – 2nd Ordinary Elections to 23 Urban Local Bodies – Pre-Election activities are in progress – **Local procurement of election material** – Certain instructions issued – Regarding.

Ref:
1. This office Circular Roc.No.13021/122/2026/H1, dated 22.08.2026.
2. Notification No.865/SEC-F2/2026, dated 17.10.2026 of the State Election Commissioner, Vijayawada.
3. Notification No.866/SEC-F1/2026, dated 17.10.2026 of the State Election Commissioner, Vijayawada.

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The attention of the Municipal Commissioners of the 23 Urban Local Bodies (ULBs) mentioned in the address entry is invited to the references cited and inform that the delimitation of wards in the concerned ULBs has been completed and as per the notifications issued by the A.P. State Election Commission (APSEC), the ward-wise Photo Electoral Rolls, prepared with reference to 01.01.2026 as the qualifying date, are scheduled to be published on 24.10.2026. Upon publication of the electoral rolls, the concerned ULBs shall take up a survey for identification of Scheduled Caste (SC), Scheduled Tribe (ST), Backward Class (BC) and Women voters, ward-wise and ensure that the exercise is completed expeditiously in accordance with the instructions issued by the competent authorities.

2. It is further informed that the A.P. State Election Commission is expected to issue the election notification shortly for the 23 ULBs concerned. In view of the impending elections, all preparatory activities shall be taken up on a priority basis to ensure that the ULBs are fully equipped and ready for the smooth and orderly conduct of elections within the prescribed timelines.

3. Further, it is to inform that the election materials required for the conduct of elections, such as ballot boxes, indelible ink, green paper seals, handbooks, white and pink wove paper, statutory and non-statutory covers and forms, etc., are procured centrally by the Office of the Commissioner & Director of Municipal Administration, A.P., and supplied to all the 123 ULBs in the State. Whereas the remaining items, including stationery and other polling-related materials not covered under central procurement, shall be procured locally by the respective ULBs concerned, following the prescribed procedure and in accordance with the applicable rules and instructions.

4. Therefore, the Commissioners of the 23 ULBs concerned are hereby requested to take immediate steps to procure all required election materials locally, other than those supplied centrally through the C&DMA, by **30.10.2026**, without fail. The list of items to be procured locally, as specified in the Compendium of Instructions applicable to Nagar Panchayats/Municipalities and Municipal Corporations, is enclosed as **Annexure-I and Annexure-II**, as applicable.

5. The Commissioners shall ensure the safe storage of all election materials received from the C&DMA or procured locally in secure rooms with adequate protection against fire, water damage and other risks. Proper stock registers and logbooks shall be maintained and necessary watch and ward arrangements shall be made to prevent loss, damage or unauthorized access to the materials.

6. All the Regional Directors-cum-Appellate Commissioners of Municipal Administration (RDMAs) in the State are requested to closely monitor the progress of local procurement by the 23 ULBs concerned and ensure that all required election materials are procured and safely stored in secure rooms by **30.10.2026**. They shall also ensure strict compliance with the above instructions and report any delay or deviation to this office immediately.

7. Any deviation or violation of these instructions will be viewed seriously and stringent disciplinary action will be initiated against the officials responsible.

8. This matter shall be treated as **'Most Urgent and Important'.**

Encl: As above.

Election Authority and
Commissioner & Director

To

The Commissioners of Srikakulam, Rajamahendravaram, Kakinada and Mangalagiri Tadepali Municipal Corporations.

The Municipal Commissioners of Bhimavaram, Tadepalligudem, Gudivada, Palacole, Tanuku, YSR Tadigadapa, Bapatla, Narsarapet, Kavali, Srikalahasti, Gudur (N), Amadalavalasa, Ponnur, Kandukur, Rajam, Chintalapudi, Podili, Alluru and B.Kothakota.

All the Regional Directors-cum-Appellate Commissioners of Municipal Administration (RDMAs) in the State.

Copy to:

All the District Election Authorities and Collectors & District Magistrates in the State.

The Secretary, A.P. State Election Commission, Vijayawada, for information.

The Principal Secretary, MA&UD Dept., Government of A.P., Secretariat, Velagapudi, Amaravati, for information.

SC/SF.

Free, Fair and Peaceful Elections

are possible only by your active participation

Thank You

Commissioner & Director of Municipal Administration,
Government of A.P.